Northfield University Office of Information Technology

Approved Cloud Services Registry

Field	Detail
Registry Number	NUOIT-REG-2026-003
Version	2.4
Effective Date	May 1, 2026
Last Updated	September 15, 2026
Registry Owner	Cloud Governance and Architecture
Approved By	Chief Information Security Officer and IT Governance Board

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1.0 Purpose

This registry identifies externally hosted platforms that Northfield University has assessed for institutional use. Approval is specific to the data classifications and service configurations shown here. A vendor's appearance in this registry does not authorize every product offered by that vendor.

University agreements, tenant controls, identity integration, and data protection terms distinguish an approved institutional service from a consumer account. Users must access every service through the Northfield tenant and university single sign-on. Personal subscriptions and free-tier accounts are not approved for institutional data above Level 1.

1.1 Hosted Service Categories

The Office of IT describes hosted platforms by function rather than by consumer marketing terminology:

- **Collaborative content workspaces** support documents, messages, and team files.
- **Managed object persistence** stores research files and application objects in durable buckets.
- **Controlled analytics enclaves** provide isolated computation and storage for regulated datasets.
- **Ephemeral transfer zones** support time-limited exchange and are not systems of record.

1.2 General Conditions

All approved services must use Northfield single sign-on and multi-factor authentication. Data owners remain responsible for classification, minimum-necessary access, retention, and legal or sponsor restrictions. Procurement through a university agreement is mandatory.

2.0 Approved Service Matrix

Institutional Service	Permitted Data	Required Configuration	Prohibited Use
Northfield Collaboration Drive	Levels 1 and 2	Northfield tenant, SSO, MFA, external sharing disabled by default	Level 3 or 4 data
Northfield Research Vault	Levels 1, 2, and 3	Research project workspace, named data owner, annual access review, encryption at rest	Level 4 data and public links
Secure Enclave Object Repository	Levels 1 through 4	Controlled analytics enclave, CISO approval, named-user allowlist, quarterly access review, customer-managed encryption keys	Anonymous access, public endpoints, consumer credentials
Northfield Managed Object Store	Levels 1, 2, and 3	Private bucket, university organization account, encryption and versioning enabled	Level 4 data without enclave controls
Temporary Transfer Zone	Levels 1 and 2	Links expire within seven days; recipient authentication required	Long-term retention or regulated datasets

2.1 Confidential Research Material

Level 3 research material may use **Northfield Research Vault** or **Northfield Managed Object Store**. The workspace or bucket must be private, encryption at rest must be enabled, and access must be limited to project members with a documented need to know. A data protection agreement is already incorporated into the university contracts for these institutional configurations.

Level 3 material must not be placed in Northfield Collaboration Drive, a personal file-sharing account, or a bucket outside the university organization. Public link sharing is prohibited.

2.2 Restricted and Regulated Datasets

Level 4 material, including protected health information and export-controlled technical data, may be persisted only in the **Secure Enclave Object Repository** after written CISO approval. The approved pattern is called a **controlled analytics enclave**. It combines a named-user allowlist, customer-managed encryption keys, private network endpoints, immutable audit logs, and quarterly access review.

A general-purpose cloud drive, ordinary object bucket, or personal subscription is not an approved persistence target for Level 4 material. Researchers must submit the Hosted Research Environment Review before transferring any regulated dataset.

3.0 Retention, Backup, and Recovery

3.1 Northfield Research Vault

Research Vault provides daily snapshots retained for **35 days**. Deleted files remain recoverable by project owners for 30 days and by OIT backup administrators for an additional five days. Research Vault is a working repository, not a permanent archive. At project close, the principal investigator must select records for transfer to the Research Archive.

3.2 Managed Object Persistence

Northfield Managed Object Store and Secure Enclave Object Repository use versioning and cross-zone replication. Backup and recovery targets are:

- Recovery point objective: no more than 24 hours.
- Recovery time objective: no more than 8 hours for standard buckets and 24 hours for enclave repositories.
- Deleted object versions: retained for 90 days.
- Audit records: retained for seven years for enclave repositories and one year for standard buckets.

3.3 Temporary Transfer Zone

Files in Temporary Transfer Zone are automatically deleted **seven days** after upload. The service does not provide backup or recovery. It must never be treated as durable storage or the authoritative copy of a university record.

4.0 Exception Process

A data owner who cannot meet a research or operational requirement with a listed service must submit a Cloud Service Exception through the IT Governance Portal. The request must include the data classification, proposed architecture, vendor assessment, contractual terms, risk analysis, and compensating controls.

Exceptions for Level 3 require approval from Cloud Governance and the data owner. Exceptions involving Level 4 require written approval from the CISO and Office of General Counsel. Approvals expire after twelve months unless renewed.

5.0 Service Support and Incident Reporting

Operational incidents should be reported to the IT Service Desk. Suspected unauthorized access, accidental public sharing, credential exposure, or loss of Level 3 or Level 4 material must be reported to the CSIRT immediately under the Cybersecurity Incident Response Plan.

6.0 Revision History

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| Version | Date | Description |
| 2.2 | January 10, 2025 | Added Research Vault institutional agreement |
| 2.3 | May 1, 2026 | Added controlled analytics enclave requirements |
| 2.4 | September 15, 2026 | Clarified managed object persistence and transfer-zone retention |
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